



United States
Attorney's Office
Eastern District of Louisiana



Physician Convicted of Conspiracy to Defraud Medicare

Thursday, November 20, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Eastern District of Louisiana

shane.jones@usdoj.gov

Editor's Note: This matter occurred on date indicated but not published at that time due to government shutdown. Press release posted and made available following the return to normal operations.

NEW ORLEANS – Acting United States Attorney Michael M. Simpson announced that **DR. MARION LEE ("LEE")**, age 62, of Cordele, Georgia, pled guilty on October 8, 2025 to conspiracy to defraud the United States, in violation of 18 U.S.C. § 371, in connection with a scheme to bill Medicare approximately \$24 million for medically unnecessary genetic testing, and to pay and receive kickbacks.

According to court documents, **LEE**, co-owner of and medical advisor to Luminus Diagnostics, a diagnostic laboratory located in Tifton, Georgia, conspired with others to procure orders for genetic testing in exchange for kickbacks, including orders acquired through purported telemedicine. To ensure the false and fraudulent claims would be paid, **LEE** and his co-conspirators designed the genetic testing order forms to be "dummy proof"—with prepopulated diagnosis codes and check-the-box panels—and frequently billed the tests through another laboratory in the Eastern District of Louisiana where co-conspirators thought the claims were more likely to be approved. The co-conspirators concealed these claims via a sham contract, among other deceptive means. **LEE** and his co-conspirators caused the submission of over \$24 million in false and fraudulent claims to Medicare for genetic testing, and Medicare paid approximately \$4 million based on those claims. Under the terms of **LEE's** plea agreement, **LEE** agreed to over \$4 million in restitution owed to Medicare.

The Honorable Lance M. Africk set sentencing for March 18, 2026.

At sentencing, the maximum penalty **LEE** may receive is five years of imprisonment, followed by up to three years of supervised release. He also faces a fine of up to \$250,000, and payment of a mandatory

special assessment fee of \$100.

Acting U.S. Attorney Simpson praised the work of the Department of Health and Human Services Office of Inspector General and the Federal Bureau of Investigation in investigating this matter. Assistant United States Attorney Nicholas D. Moses, of the Financial Crimes Unit and Health Care Fraud Coordinator, and Trial Attorney Kelly Z. Walters, of the Department of Justice’s Criminal Division’s Fraud Section, are in charge of the prosecution.

Contact

Shane M. Jones

Public Information Officer

United States Attorney’s Office, Eastern District of Louisiana

United States Department of Justice

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Topic

HEALTHCARE FRAUD

Components

[Criminal Division](#) | [Criminal - Criminal Fraud Section](#) | [Federal Bureau of Investigation \(FBI\)](#)

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PRESS RELEASE

National Health Care Fraud Takedown Results in 455 Defendants Charged in Fraud Scheme Totaling Over \$6.5 Billion

Today, United States Attorney David I. Courcelle announced criminal charges against two defendants in connection with alleged schemes to defraud Medicare, Medicaid, and TRICARE, and other health care benefit programs.

June 23, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Slidell Doctor Sentenced For \$6.6 Million In Health Care Fraud

NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA – ROBERT TASSIN, M.D. ("TASSIN"), age 67, of Slidell, Louisiana, was sentenced on April 9, 2026, for conspiracy to commit healthcare fraud, in violation of 18...

April 10, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Georgia Chiropractor Convicted Of Healthcare Fraud

NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA –United States Attorney David I. Courcelle announced that **STEVEN D. PEYROUX ("PEYROUX")**, age 56, of Canton, Georgia, pled guilty on January 15, 2026 to conspiracy to commit...

January 23, 2026

